



HELIX

Secure Clinical Communication Platform

How-To Guide

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Getting Started

The following guides walk you through every aspect of the HELIX platform from first login to core functionalities. Each guide is written as a step-by-step walkthrough.

1. Set Up Your Profile

2. Navigate the Home Screen

1. Upon logging in, the Home screen displays your name and role at the top.
2. The Code Blue button is prominently shown at the top - tap it only to activate a cardiac arrest alert.
3. Scroll down to see the Broadcasts section showing recent facility-wide announcements.
4. Below Broadcasts is your Notifications feed with role changes, reminders, and escalation alerts.
5. The bottom navigation bar gives access to Home, Chats, Calls, Roles, Explore, and Patients.
6. Tap the wrench/settings icon near your name to access tools like Reminders and to Contact Helix Health Support.

Messaging

3. Start a New One-on-One Chat

1. Tap 'Chats' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Tap the '+' icon in the top right corner.
3. Select 'Start new chat'.
4. You will have the option to Send as Yourself (Your Name) or as the Role You are covering.
5. Tap the '+ Add recipient' button to select the Person or Role you want to message.
6. You can add a Subject or Patient (Optional).
7. Type your message in the text field at the bottom.
8. Tap the send arrow to deliver the message.
9. A delivery checkmark will appear once the message is received.

 *Tip: You can also start a chat directly from a user's profile in the Explore tab.*

To send a Critical Message, tap the  symbol before sending. The message field will turn red, and a red "Critical Message" label will appear above it, indicating the message will be flagged as urgent and trigger

priority delivery and escalation (if there is an escalation policy for a role) if unacknowledged.

4. Start a Group Chat

1. Tap 'Chats' then tap the '+' icon.
2. Tap 'New Group' from the options that appear.
3. You will have the option to Send as Yourself (Your Name) or as the Role You are covering.
4. Tap 'Add Members' to add members to the group.
5. Give the group a name (e.g., 'Ward 3 Night Team').
6. All members will receive a notification that they have been added.
7. Type your message in the text field at the bottom.
8. Tap the send arrow to deliver the message.
9. A delivery checkmark will appear once the message is received.

 *Tip: Group chats are ideal for care team coordination, shift handovers, and multi-disciplinary rounds.*

To send a Critical Message, tap the  symbol before sending. The message field will turn red, and a red "Critical Message" label will appear above it, indicating the message will be flagged as urgent and trigger priority delivery and escalation (if there is an escalation policy for a role) if unacknowledged.

5. Send a Message to a Role (Role-Based Messaging)

1. Tap 'Chats' then tap the '+' icon.
2. Select 'Message a Role'.
3. Search for the role by name (e.g., 'HH - Cardiologist On-Call' or 'ED Charge Nurse').
4. Tap the role to open a conversation addressed to whoever is currently covering it.
5. Type and send your message.
6. HELIX automatically routes the message to the active person covering that role.
7. If no one is currently covering, HELIX will notify you and MAY escalate accordingly.

 *Tip: Role-based messaging means you never have to look up who is on call - HELIX handles routing automatically.*

6. Send a File or Image in a Chat

1. Open any chat conversation.
2. Tap the '+' icon in the lower left corner just beside the text field.
3. To send a PDF (e.g., lab result, referral letter) tap the attachment icon and browse your files.
4. To send a Photo or Video, choose 'Photo/Video' to send an existing image, or 'Camera' to take a new photo.
5. You can also send Patient Information.
6. You can add an optional caption or note to the file being sent.
7. Tap 'Send'. The file will be uploaded securely and appear in the conversation thread.

 *Tip: All shared files are encrypted in transit and at rest, fully compliant with Data Protection requirements.*

7. Check Message Delivery and Read Status

1. Open any sent message in a chat conversation.
2. A single checkmark (✓) means the message has been sent from your device.
3. A double checkmark (✓✓) in grey means the message has been delivered to the recipient's device.
4. A double checkmark (✓✓) in green means the message has been read by the recipient.
5. For group chats, tap and hold the message to see individual read receipts.
6. For critical messages, HELIX also logs the delivery and read events in the audit trail.

8. Search Within a Chat Conversation

1. Open the chat conversation you want to search.
2. Tap your name at the top of the screen.
3. Tap the search icon (magnifying glass) at the top of the screen.
4. Type a keyword, patient name, or phrase.
5. HELIX will highlight all matching messages within that conversation.
6. Scroll through results using the up/down arrows.
7. Tap any result to jump to that point in the conversation history.

Calls

9. Make a Voice Call

1. Tap 'Calls' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Use the Quick Call section at the top to instantly dial a frequently contacted colleague.
3. Or tap the search icon (magnifying glass) at the top of the screen to search for a contact by name, role, or department.
4. Tap the phone icon next to the contact's name.
5. Select 'Helix Call' or 'Normal phone call' from the options.

10. Make a Video Call

1. Tap 'Calls' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Use the Quick Call section at the top to instantly dial a frequently contacted colleague.
3. Or tap the search icon (magnifying glass) at the top of the screen to search for a contact by name, role, or department.
4. Tap the phone icon next to the contact's name.
5. Select 'Helix Video' or 'Normal phone call' from the options.
6. Grant camera and microphone permissions if prompted for the first time.
7. Use the on-screen controls to mute, switch camera, or end the call.

11. View and Return a Missed Call

1. Tap 'Calls' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Missed calls appear in your Recent calls list highlighted in red.
3. The name of the caller (or the role/group) and the time of the missed call are shown.
4. Tap the phone icon to the right of the missed call to call back immediately.
5. Alternatively, tap the caller's name to view their profile and message them instead.

Roles

12. View the Roles Directory

1. Tap 'Roles' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. The Roles Directory lists all roles configured at your facility.
3. Three tabs are available: All Roles, Saved Roles, and Active Roles.
4. Each role entry shows the role name, a brief description, and the person currently covering it (shown in green).
5. If a role has no one covering it, it displays 'No one covering' in red.
6. Tap any role to see full details including who is or was covering it, escalation policy and contact options.

13. Sign In to a Role

1. Tap 'Roles' from the bottom navigation bar.
2. Find the role you are about to cover using the search bar or scrolling.
3. Tap the role to open its detail page.
4. Under 'Role management' you get an option 'Swipe right to sign in'.
5. Swipe to sign in.
6. You are now the active responder for all messages and calls directed to this role.
7. Your name will appear under the role in the directory in green.
8. Team members will receive a notification that you have signed in to the role.

 *Tip: Always sign in to your role at the start of a shift to ensure messages are routed to you correctly.*

14. Sign Out of a Role and Transfer Coverage

1. Tap 'Roles' and find the role you are currently covering.
2. Tap the role to open its detail page.
3. Tap 'Swipe left to sign out'.
4. For some roles HELIX will prompt you to select who will take over the role next.
5. The new person will receive a notification that they now cover the role.
6. The Roles Directory will update immediately to reflect the new coverage.
7. Alternatively, you can tap on the Home screen, tap on your role being covered right under your name and 'Swipe left to sign out' on its detail page.

 *Tip: For Standard Priority roles, you can simply swipe out of your role without needing to assign a replacement - HELIX will sign you out immediately. For Critical Priority roles, HELIX will not allow you to sign out until you have signed in another caregiver to take over. This is a*

deliberate safeguard to ensure continuity of care and guarantee that life-critical roles are never left uncovered. You must search for and confirm your replacement before the sign-out is completed.

15. Save a Role for Quick Access

1. Tap 'Roles' from the bottom navigation bar.
2. Find the role you frequently contact (e.g., HH - Chief Medical Officer).
3. Tap the bookmark icon to the right of the role name.
4. The role is now saved under the 'Saved Roles' tab.
5. Access your saved roles anytime by tapping the 'Saved Roles' tab at the top of the Roles screen.
6. Tap any saved role to message or call whoever is currently covering it.

16. Message the Person Covering a Role

1. Tap 'Roles' and find the role you need to contact.
2. Tap the role to open its detail page.
3. Note the name of the person currently covering the role.
4. Tap 'Message Role' to send a message that is routed to the current coverage.
5. Type your message and tap Send.
6. The message is delivered to that person's HELIX inbox instantly.

Explore

17. Search for Internal Staff

1. Tap 'Explore' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Ensure the 'Internal' tab is selected (highlighted in dark blue).
3. Type a name, specialty, or department in the search bar (e.g., 'Radiologist' or 'Boateng').
4. Browse or scroll the alphabetical staff list.
5. Each entry shows the staff member's name, department, specialty, and last-seen time.
6. Tap a staff member's name to view their full profile and initiate a call or message.

 *Tip: Last-seen status (e.g., 'Last seen 4 hours ago') indicates how recently the user was active on the platform.*

18. Search for Roles at External Facilities

1. Tap 'Explore' then tap the 'External' tab.
2. Browse the list of external facility roles (mostly the Transfer Centers of other hospitals).
3. Or type a facility name or role in the search bar.
4. Tap any external role to see its description and contact options.
5. Tap 'Message Role' to send a secure message to that external facility.
6. Tap 'Request Transfer' to initiate a patient transfer request with the other facility.
7. All external messaging remains encrypted and Data Compliant.

 *Tip: Use the External tab to reach transfer centers when arranging patient transfers to other hospitals.*

19. Initiate a Patient Transfer via HELIX

1. Tap 'Explore' in the bottom navigation bar, then tap the 'External' tab.
2. Browse or search for the Transfer Center of the receiving facility (e.g., XYZ Transfer Center or BRH Transfer Center).
3. Tap the Transfer Center to open its External Contact page - you will see the facility name, department, and priority level listed under Details.
4. You will see two options - tap 'Request Transfer' to use the structured transfer form or tap 'Message' to send a direct message to the transfer center.
5. If using 'Request Transfer', a form will appear pre-addressed to the receiving Transfer Center. Fill in the following:
 - Send as:** The Sender is prefilled as you.
 - Requesting Physician:** Tap '+ Add Physician' to add the requesting physician's name.
 - Patient Details:** Enter the patient's First Name, Last Name, Date of Birth, Gender, and Primary Diagnosis.
 - Transfer Details:** Enter the reason for transfer.
 - Additional Information:** Add any optional supporting notes.
6. Use the toolbar at the bottom to attach documents or media files (+), add a voice note, or flag the request as critical () if the transfer is urgent.
7. Tap 'Send' to submit the transfer request - it will be routed to whoever is on duty at the receiving Transfer Center.
8. Await confirmation of bed availability and acceptance via HELIX message.
9. Document the transfer communication in the patient's care record as appropriate.

 *Tip: HELIX creates a full audit trail of all transfer communications including who sent the request, when it was delivered, and when it was acknowledged - which can be referenced for compliance and handover purposes.*

💡 Tip: If a Transfer Center is classified as a Critical Priority role. If the transfer is urgent, tap the  symbol before sending to flag it as a critical message, ensuring immediate escalation if unacknowledged.

Patient Management

20. View Your Patient List

1. Tap 'Patients' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. The 'My Patients' tab (default) shows all patients currently assigned to you.
3. Each entry shows the patient's name, age, sex, room number, unit, bed and assigned care team.
4. Tap any patient name to open their detail view.
5. Use the 'Saved' tab to access bookmarked patients.
6. Use the 'All Patients' tab to search the full facility patient list sorted into Units.

21. Add a New Patient

1. Tap 'Patients' then tap the '+' icon in the top right corner.
2. Enter the patient's full details as required.
3. Tap 'Save' to create the patient record.

💡 Tip: Patient records created in HELIX are for care coordination purposes. Always ensure data is consistent with your EMR.

22. Create a Patient's Care Team

1. Tap 'Patients' in the bottom navigation bar.
2. Search for the patient by name using the search bar, or browse the patient list each entry shows the patient's name, age, sex, room, bed, and ward/unit (e.g., ICU West, Medical Ward, Pediatric OPD).
3. Tap the patient's name to open their profile page.
4. You will see the patient's Location Details (Room & Bed, Unit) and a Care Team section below showing the current number of members.
5. If no care team has been assigned yet, the Care Team section will show '0 Members' and the 'Message Care Team' button will appear greyed out.
6. Tap the '+' button next to the Members count to begin adding team members.
7. An 'Add to Care Team' search screen will appear - search by name, specialty, or department to find the provider you want to add (e.g., Dr. Badu, Simon-Neurology & Neurosurgery · Consultant).
8. Tap on a provider's name to select them - you can add multiple members one after another.

9. Tap the ✓ (checkmark) in the top right corner to confirm and save the care team.
10. The Care Team section will now display all added members with their role and the time they joined (e.g., Resident | Joined Just now).

23. Managing Individual Care Team Members

Once members are added, tap the : (three-dot menu) next to any team member to access the following options:

1. **Message**-Send a direct message to that team member.
2. **Remove from team**-Remove them from the patient's care team.
3. **Make attending physician**-Designate them as the lead physician for this patient.
4. **Make first contact**-Set them as the primary point of contact for this patient.
5. Once the care team has at least one member, tap 'Message Care Team' to open the shared care team group chat for that patient.

💡 Tip: Always build the care team as soon as a patient is admitted so all providers are connected from the start and no communication is missed.

The care team chat is automatically linked to the patient's profile - all messages, updates, and shared documents within it are tied to that patient's record for easy reference and audit.

Broadcasts & Critical Alerts

24. Send a Broadcast Message

1. On the Home screen, tap the '+' button next to 'View all' in the Broadcasts section.
2. Enter a title for the broadcast (e.g., 'ED at Capacity').
3. Type the full message body with relevant details.
4. Select the recipients: all staff (everyone), specific departments, or selected roles.
5. Review the broadcast before sending.
6. Tap 'Send'-all selected recipients receive an immediate push notification.

💡 Tip: Keep broadcast messages concise and action oriented. Avoid sending non-urgent information as a broadcast.

25. Activate a Code Blue Alert

1. On the Home screen, tap the large 'Code Blue' button at the top of the screen.
2. A confirmation dialog will appear -it includes a location field, enter or confirm the location of the emergency.
3. HELIX immediately sends an alert to all members of the resuscitation team per your facility's protocol.
4. The alert is logged with a timestamp and the identity of who activated it.
5. All recipients will receive a high-priority push notification and in-app alert.

 *Tip: The Code Blue button is designed for immediate one-tap activation. Familiarize yourself with its location before an emergency occurs.*

26. View All Received Broadcasts

1. On the Home screen, tap 'View all' next to the Broadcasts section.
2. Alternatively, navigate to the Broadcasts screen from the menu.
3. Tap 'Received' to see all broadcasts sent to you.
4. Tap 'Sent' to see all broadcasts you have previously sent.
5. Tap any broadcast to read the full message and see who read the broadcast.
6. Use the search bar to find a specific broadcast by keyword.

Notifications & Reminders

27. View Your Notifications

1. On the Home screen, scroll down to the Notifications section.
2. Tap 'View all' to see the complete notifications feed.
3. Notifications include role sign-in/out events, shared reminders, escalation alerts, and system updates.
4. Unread notifications are highlighted-tap to mark them as read.

28. Set a Personal Reminder

1. From the Home screen, tap the wrench/tools icon near your name in the top right corner.
2. A Tools menu will appear at the bottom of the screen with two options - tap 'Reminders'.
3. The Reminders screen will open, showing tabs for All, Upcoming, and Past reminders.
4. Tap the '+' icon in the top right corner to create a new reminder.

5. A 'New Reminder' form will appear. Fill in the following:
Title - Enter a short title for the reminder (e.g., 'Review patient discharge summary').
Description - Add any additional details or notes about the reminder.
Due -Tap the date and time fields to set when the reminder is due.
Repeat -Tap to set a repeat frequency (e.g., Never, Daily, Weekly) if the reminder is recurring.
Early Alert- Tap to choose how far in advance you want to be notified: Off (notify at due time only), 5 minutes before, 10 minutes before, 15 minutes before, 30 minutes before, or 1 hour before.
6. Leave Share set to 'Only you' for a personal reminder.
7. Tap the ✓ (checkmark) in the top right corner to save the reminder.
8. HELIX will send you a push notification at the scheduled time.

 *Tip: Use the Upcoming tab to see all reminders that haven't triggered yet, and the Past tab to review reminders that have already been delivered.*

29. Share a Reminder with a Colleague

1. Follow steps 1–5 above to create a new reminder and fill in the Title, Description, Due date/time, Repeat, and Early Alert settings.
2. Before saving, tap the 'Share' field-it will show 'Only you' by default.
3. A Share screen will appear with a searchable list of all staff (People and Roles).
4. Search for and tap the name(s) of the colleague(s) you want to share the reminder with.
5. You can add multiple people - each new invitee defaults to View only access.
6. Tap the ✓ (checkmark) in the top right to confirm your selections and return to the reminder form.
7. Tap the ✓ (checkmark) again at the top of the New Reminder screen to save and send.
8. All selected colleagues will receive the reminder notification at the set time on their devices

Escalation

30. Understand How Auto-Escalation Works

1. When you send a critical message to a role with an Escalation ladder, HELIX monitors whether the recipient acknowledges it.
2. If there is no acknowledgment within the configured timeout (e.g., 2 minutes), HELIX escalates automatically.

3. Escalation routes the message to the next person in the configured escalation chain (e.g., supervisor or backup on-call).
4. Each escalation step is logged with the timestamp and the recipient at each level.
5. Escalation continues until someone acknowledges the message.
6. The original sender is notified when the message has been acknowledged and by whom.

 *Tip: Admins will configure escalation chains in advance for each department to ensure critical alerts always reach someone.*

31. Acknowledge a Critical Alert

1. When a critical alert arrives, your device will sound loudly and/or vibrate and display a high-priority push notification.
2. You can access HELIX by tapping on the notification or open HELIX and navigate to the message.
3. Read the alert carefully.
4. Press and hold the message and a dialogue will pop up with the option to 'Acknowledge' the message to confirm you have received and noted it.
5. Your acknowledgment is logged with your name and a timestamp.
6. If applicable, reply with your intended action (e.g., 'On my way').
7. Failure to acknowledge within the timeout window will trigger escalation to the next provider or supervisor if you are logged into a role. If it is a personal message, the alert will ring until you acknowledge the message.

Settings & Security

32. Manage Your Account Settings & Profile Visibility

1. From the Home screen, tap your profile photo in the top right corner.
2. Your profile page will open showing your full details - name, qualification, Employee ID, username, email, and phone number.
3. If your phone number shows 'Not verified - tap to verify' in red, tap it to complete phone verification for your account.
4. Scroll down to the Activity section where you can access Reminders (view and manage all your personal and shared reminders) and Signing History (see a full log of your recent role sign-ins and sign-outs).
5. Tap 'Settings' (Privacy, app lock, and visibility) to open the Settings screen.
6. From the Settings screen, configure the following:
Status - Do Not Disturb: Toggle on to pause incoming message notifications. When active, no standard message notifications will be delivered until it is turned off.

Security - App Lock: Toggle on to require a PIN or biometric (Face ID / fingerprint) every time the app is opened, adding an extra layer of protection.

Change Password: Tap to update your HELIX sign-in password.

Notifications - Hide Message Preview: Toggle on to hide message content from appearing on your lock screen notifications.

Profile Visibility - Show email to others: Toggle on or off to control whether colleagues can see your email address when viewing your profile.

Show phone to others: Toggle on or off to control whether colleagues can see your phone number when viewing your profile.

About - App & Device: Tap to view your current app version, build number, and device details. Share this information with Helix Health support when reporting a technical issue.

💡 Tip: If you are unsure whether your device will receive critical alerts, use 'Send test critical notification' to verify before your shift begins especially after changing any notification or DND settings on your phone.

33. Change Your Password

1. Tap your profile icon from the Home screen.
2. Go to 'Settings' then 'Security'.
3. Tap 'Change Password'.
4. Enter your current password.
5. Enter your new password.
6. Re-enter the new password to confirm.
7. Tap 'Update' - you will need to log in again on all devices with the new password.

34. Sign Out of All Roles or Log Out of HELIX

1. From the Home screen, tap your profile photo in the top right corner.
2. Scroll to the bottom of your profile page. You will see three options:
 - Switch Account** - Tap to switch between multiple HELIX accounts on the same device (e.g., if you manage accounts across more than one facility).
 - Sign out of all roles** - Tap to immediately end your shift and release all active roles you are currently covering. This does not log you out of the app -you remain signed in but are no longer the active responder for any role.
 - Logout (shown in red)** - Tap to fully sign out of HELIX on this device. You will need to enter your credentials to log back in.
1. For 'Sign out of all roles', confirm the action when prompted - all roles will be released simultaneously, and the Roles Directory will update immediately.
2. For 'Logout', confirm the action - you will be signed out of the app immediately on this device only. Other devices where you are logged in will remain active.

 *Tip: Use 'Sign out of all roles' at the end of your shift if you want to stop receiving role-based messages but keep the app open. Use 'Logout' only when you are finished using the device entirely.*

35. Log Out of HELIX Securely

1. Tap your profile icon on the Home screen.
2. Scroll to the bottom of the profile menu.
3. Tap 'Logout' (shown in red).
4. Confirm the action -you will be signed out of the app immediately.
5. No sensitive data remains on the device after logout.
6. If you are covering a role, ensure you transfer role coverage before logging out.

 *Tip: Always log out of HELIX when using a shared or borrowed device.*

36. Understand Data Encryption in HELIX

1. All messages sent through HELIX are encrypted end-to-end using industry-standard protocols.
2. Data is encrypted both in transit (while being sent) and at rest (while stored on servers).
3. Encryption keys are managed by Helix Health Technologies' secure infrastructure.
4. No third party (including mobile carriers or internet providers) can read your HELIX messages.
5. Patient data shared within HELIX conversations is protected under Data Protection storage policies.
6. For a detailed technical security overview, contact info@helixhealth.app.

Troubleshooting

37. Troubleshoot Login Issues

1. Ensure you are entering the correct email address and password.
2. Check that your internet connection is active.
3. If you have forgotten your password, tap 'Forgot Password' on the login screen and follow the email reset instructions.
4. If your account has been deactivated, contact your HELIX facility admin.
5. If none of the above work, uninstall and reinstall the HELIX app.
6. For persistent login issues, contact Helix Health support at support@helixhealth.app or +233 54 357 1525.